

Alfa-D Capsule

COMPOSITION:

Alfa-D 0.25mcg Capsule: Each vegetable capsule contains Alfacalcidol 0.25mcg.

Alfa-D 1.00mcg Capsule: Each vegetable capsule contains Alfacalcidol 1.00mcg.

We would like to updated product description.

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION:

Alfa-D 0.25mcg Capsule -Two pieces, white, size '2' hard vegetable capsules containing yellowish semisolid mass.

Alfa-D 1.00mcg Capsule - Two pieces, brick red, size '2' hard vegetable capsules containing yellowish semisolid mass.

PHARMACOLOGY:

Alfacalcidol is the metabolite of vitamin D and it acts as a regulator of calcium and phosphate metabolism. In the body, alfacalcidol is converted to calcitriol (1, 25- dihydroxyvitamin D3). The maintenance of normal calcium and phosphate concentrations is achieved by facilitation of intestinal calcium and phosphate absorption and reabsorption of calcium in the distal renal tubule.

PHARMACOKINETICS:

Alfacalcidol is well absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract. Alfacalcidol itself is inactive and must undergo 25-hydroxylation to 1, 25-dihydroxyvitamin D3 (Calcitriol) in the liver to elicit metabolites effects.

The reported elimination half-life of alfacalcidol in serum is approximately 3 hours in normal subjects. Alfacalcidol is excreted mainly in the bile and feaces with only small amount appearing in urine.

INDICATION:

Disease caused by disturbances in the calcium metabolism as a consequence of reduced endogenous production of 1,25-dihydroxyvitamin D3.

Renal osteodystrophy, postoperative or idiopathic hypoparathyroidism, pseudohypoparathyroidism, as adjunct to the management of tertiary hyperparathyroidism, vitamin D-resistant rickets or osteomalacia, vitamin D-dependent rickets, neonatal hypocalcaemia or rickets, malabsorptive of calcium, osteoporosis, malabsorptive and nutritional rickets, and osteomalacia.

RECOMMENDED DOSE:

Adults:

Usual starting dose is 1 mcg/day.

The dose maybe adjusted by increments of 0.25-0.5mcg. Plasma levels should be measured at weekly intervals initially. When the dose is stabilized, the measurements may be taken every 2-4 weeks. Most people respond to doses between 1 – 3 mcg/day.

When there is biochemical or radiographic evidence of bone healing, the dose may be decreased. The general maintenance dose is 0.25 – 1mcg / day.

Elderly:

The usual starting dose is 0.5mcg /day.

Children between 5 to 20kg:

The usual starting dose is 0.05mcg/kg body weight /day.

Children 20kg and above:

The usual starting dose is 1mcg/day.

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

Contraindicated when there is a biochemical evidence of hypercalcaemia.

Known hypersensitivity to alfacalcidol, vitamin D or any of its analogues and derivatives.

WARNING AND PRECAUTION:

During treatment with Alfa-D Capsule, serum calcium and serum phosphate should be monitored regularly especially in children, patients with renal impairment and patients receiving high doses. Alfa-D Capsule should be used with caution for patients being treated with cardioactive glycosides or digitalis.

INTERACTIONS WITH OTHER MEDICATIONS:

- There is an increased risk of hypercalcaemia if vitamin D is given with thiazide diuretics, calcium, or phosphate. Plasma- calcium concentrations should be monitored in such situation.
- Some antiepileptics may increase vitamin D requirements (e.g. carbamazepine, phenobarbital, phenytoin, and primidone.)
- Rifampicin and isoniazid may reduce the effectiveness of vitamin D.
- Corticosteroids may counteract the effect of vitamin D.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

If you are pregnant or breastfeeding, Alfa-D Capsule should only be used if considered essential by the physician.

SIDE EFFECTS:

Excessive intake of alfacalcidol may lead to the development of hypercalcaemia.

OVERDOSE AND TREATMENT:

Hypercalcaemia can be rapidly corrected by stopping treatment until plasma calcium levels return to normal. Severe hypercalcaemia may require intervention with loop diuretics, IV fluids and corticosteroids.

STORAGE CONDITION:

Store in a dry place below 30°C.

The statement of 'Keep bottle tightly closed' has been removed.

SHELF-LIFE:

3 years

PACK SIZE:**Alfa-D 0.25mcg Capsule:**

Blister of 10 capsules. Box of 1, 3, 6, 10, 15, 20, 25 and 50 blisters.

Alfa-D 1.00mcg Capsule

Blister of 10 capsules. Box of 1, 3, 6, 10, 15, 20, 25 and 50 blisters.

The pack sizes of bottle has been removed.

MANUFACTURED BY:

PAHANG PHARMACY SDN. BHD. (10826-K)

Lot 5979, Jalan Teratai, 5 1/2 Miles Off, Jalan Meru,
41050 Klang, Selangor Darul Ehsan.

Revised date: 18 May 2015